



# Thomas Broadside Co.

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*Founding documents, portraits, and maps,  
printed on our own press. A web store, and the  
plan to bring it traffic.*

PREPARED BY JACOB E. THOMAS, PHD  
WORKING NAME AND PRICES, FOR DISCUSSION

## I

# Sell provenance, not posters.

There are ten thousand three-dollar Declarations on Etsy, and every one of them was made in a browser. What nobody else can sell is what we already own: a working press, a family that has printed in Austin for decades, and someone who will check the quotes.

The story is ours by trade. The Revolution was made by printers. Benjamin Franklin was one. On the night of July 4, 1776, John Dunlap set the Declaration in Caslon and ran roughly two hundred broadsides before dawn. Isaiah Thomas published the *Massachusetts Spy*, moved his press out of Boston days before Lexington, and later wrote the first history of printing in America. No relation, same trade, and we will say so.

A print shop that prints the founding documents is not a novelty store. It is the original business, and the store is built to say that on every page: the source of every line, the typeface, the paper, and the press it came off. A product page that reads like a museum label.

The store has two rooms. The heritage room sells archival reproductions, sourced quotes, and numbered editions to people who are proud of their walls. The classroom room sells document sets and timelines to families and schools that need the same sheets, sized for the wall and priced for a teacher. The same sixteen designs furnish both.

What follows is the positioning, the product ladder, the first catalog, the storefront and campaigns, the calendar, a three-year projection, and the launch plan with the gate at which we decide whether to run the press again.

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## THREE HOUSE RULES

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|              |                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cited        | Every quote carries its source, date, and document, on the product page and on the sheet. If we cannot cite it, we do not print it. No spurious Jefferson.                       |
| Pre-partisan | The store belongs to the founding era, not to a party. The shop's political work stays out of it. The founding documents belong to everyone, and that is also the larger market. |
| Printed here | Every physical print comes off our press in Austin and says so. Not print on demand, not a fulfillment warehouse. This is the claim no competitor can copy.                      |

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## II

## Two rooms, one house.

## A • THE HERITAGE ROOM

Museum-grade, sourced, numbered.

Archival reproductions of the founding documents, founder portraits after Stuart, Peale, and Duplessis, period maps, and quotes with their citations set on the sheet.

Numbered editions on cotton paper with an embossed maker's mark.

**Who buys.** History readers, lawyers and judges, gift buyers, Texans, veterans' families. Price-tolerant and provenance-sensitive. They are buying something for a wall they are proud of.

**What it does for the business.** Credibility, margin, and the flagship. The edition is the gift and the press release.

## C • THE CLASSROOM ROOM

The working room.

Document sets, the timeline of the Revolution, portrait series, and Texas history, sized for the wall and priced for a teacher. Digital sets a family prints tonight; printed sets that arrive in a tube.

**Who buys.** Homeschool families, co-ops, private and charter schools, civics teachers. Volume, bundles, and a repeat purchase every August.

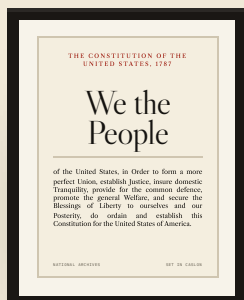
**What it does for the business.** Traffic, list growth, and the volume that keeps the press runs deep. The heritage room gives the classroom its credibility; the classroom gives heritage its volume.

## WHAT WE ARE NOT

Flags, eagles, slogans, and "We the People" on a t-shirt. That market is enormous, commoditized, politically coded, and full of print-on-demand sellers competing on price. We do not enter it, and we do not chase it during elections.

## WHY THESE TWO SHARE A HOUSE

One catalog, one press run, one set of sources. A teacher who buys the digital set in August is the same customer who buys the framed Preamble for the school office in December. The rooms share a door.



## THE SAME SHEET IN THE HERITAGE ROOM

The Preamble as a numbered edition on cotton paper, framed, **\$165**. Bought once, for an office wall.



## THE SAME SHEET IN THE CLASSROOM

The Preamble inside the Founding Documents Set, six sheets in one tube, **\$150**. Bought every August.

## III

# Digital funds the funnel. The press funds the family.

| TIER        | WHAT IT IS                                                                                                                            | PRICE          | COST         | MARGIN | ITS JOB                                                 |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Digital     | Instant download, sized for home printing at 8.5 x 11, 11 x 17, and 18 x 24. Singles and classroom sets.                              | \$7 to \$24    | near \$0     | 88%    | Search bait, email capture, the classroom's front door. |
| Press print | 18 x 24 on 100 lb cream cover, printed on our press in Austin, shipped rolled in a tube. Documents also at 24 x 36.                   | \$38 to \$65   | \$11 to \$16 | 62%    | The margin engine. Most of the revenue.                 |
| Edition     | Numbered of 250, dated, cotton paper, embossed maker's mark. Framed through a local framer. Flagship: the Dunlap broadside facsimile. | \$145 to \$350 | \$40 to \$80 | 58%    | The flagship and the gift.                              |
| Wholesale   | Sets and framed prints for law firms, schools, co-ops, museum shops, and posts. Invoiced, not carted.                                 | \$300 to \$900 | varies       | 45%    | Volume from year two.                                   |

MARGINS ARE AFTER PLATFORM FEES, PAPER, INK, PRESS TIME, TUBES, AND SHIPPING SUPPLIES. PRICES ARE WORKING FIGURES FOR DISCUSSION.

## PRESS ECONOMICS

Offset wants batches. A run of 250 to 500 sheets per design makes a tight catalog of sixteen heroes far more profitable than a thousand one-offs, so the catalog is designed around the equipment: few designs, run deep, reprinted on sell-through. A two-color job, black and red, is the whole palette. Those are the two inks of the early press.

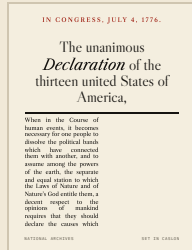
## FIRST QUESTIONS FOR THE SHOP

- What does the press do best on heavy stock, and what is the true cost of a 500-sheet run of a two-color job?
- Can we emboss, or do we partner for the maker's mark on editions?
- Which local framer takes trade pricing on a standard 18 x 24 frame?

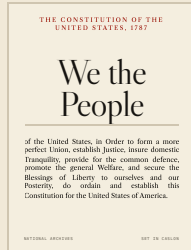
## IV

# Sixteen designs, all public domain.

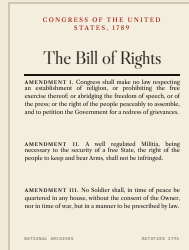
## THE DOCUMENTS • FIVE



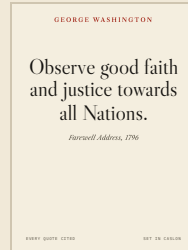
**The Declaration of Independence**  
1776 • DUNLAP SETTING



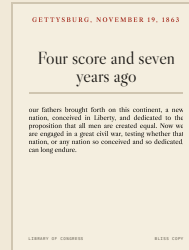
**Preamble to the Constitution**  
1787



**The Bill of Rights**  
1791



**Washington's Farewell Address**  
1796 • EXCERPT

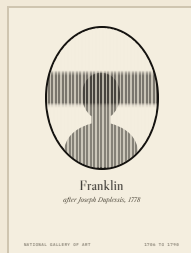


**The Gettysburg Address**  
1863 • BLISS COPY

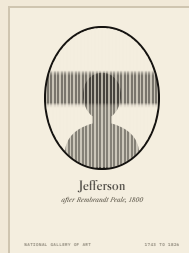
## THE FOUNDERS • FOUR • THE QUOTES • TWO



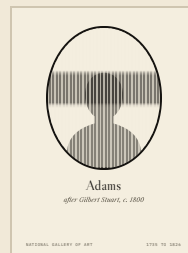
**George Washington**  
AFTER STUART, 1796



**Benjamin Franklin**  
AFTER DUPLESSIS, 1778



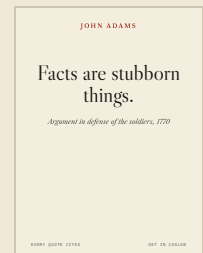
**Thomas Jefferson**  
AFTER PEALE, 1800



**John Adams**  
AFTER STUART, C. 1800

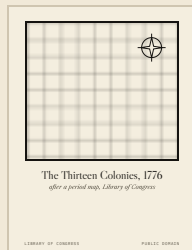


**Well done is better than well said.**  
FRANKLIN • POOR RICHARD'S, 1737

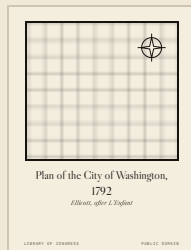


**Facts are stubborn things.**  
ADAMS • BOSTON, 1770

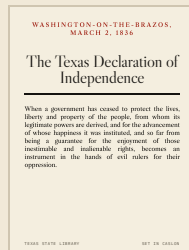
## THE MAPS • TWO • TEXAS • TWO • CLASSROOM • ONE



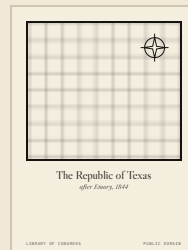
**The Thirteen Colonies**  
1776 • AFTER A PERIOD MAP



**Plan of the City of Washington**  
1792 • ELLICOTT, AFTER L'ENFANT



**The Texas Declaration of Independence**  
1836



**The Republic of Texas**  
1844 • AFTER EMORY



**The Revolution, 1765 to 1789**  
TIMELINE • CLASSROOM

**Sources.** National Archives and Library of Congress transcriptions; portrait art from National Gallery of Art open access; maps from the Library of Congress. Portrait and map thumbnails are placeholders for that art.

**Sets.** Founding Documents (five documents and the timeline), The Founders (four portraits), Texas (two sheets and a timeline). Sets are bundles of these sixteen, not new designs, so every set sells through the same press runs.

V

# The hero is the product, not a slogan.

PRINTED ON OUR OWN PRESS IN AUSTIN, TEXAS • EVERY QUOTE CITED • FREE U.S. SHIPPING ON PRINTS OVER \$75

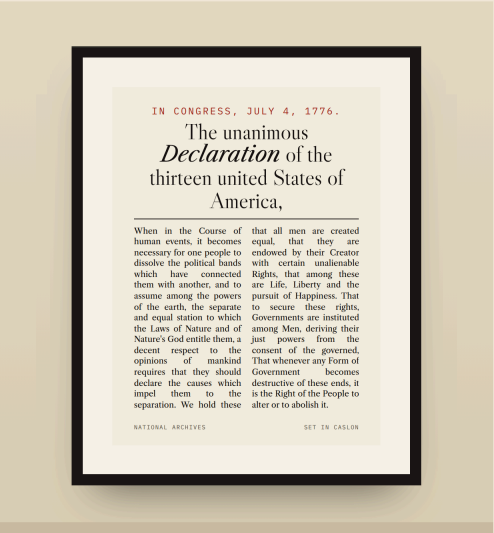
THOMAS BROADSIDE CO. Documents Founders Maps Texas Classroom The Press Journal SEARCH ACCOUNT CART (0)

FOUNDING DOCUMENTS, PRINTED HERE

## The Declaration, printed the way it was first printed.

Set in Caslon, the type of the broadside John Dunlap ran on the night of July 4, 1776. Every line from the National Archives. Printed on **heavy cream stock, on our own press**, by a family print shop in Austin, Texas.

SHOP THE DOCUMENTS SEE THE PRESS



|                                             |                                |                                      |                                         |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| SOURCE<br>National Archives, engrossed copy | TYPEFACE<br>Caslon, as in 1776 | PAPER<br>100 lb cream cover, 18 x 24 | PRESS<br>Thomas Graphics, Austin, Texas |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|

HOMEPAGE, DESKTOP. SHOPIFY. THE PROVENANCE STRIP UNDER THE HERO IS THE BRAND IN ONE LINE: SOURCE, TYPEFACE, PAPER, PRESS.

## The Documents

VIEW ALL FIVE

IN CONGRESS, JULY 4, 1776.  
The unanimous  
*Declaration* of the  
thirteen united States of  
America,

When in the Course of human events, it becomes equal, that they are necessary for one people to dissolve the political bonds which have connected them with another, and to assume among the powers of the earth, the separate and equal station to which the Laws of Nature and of Nature's God entitle them, a decent respect to the opinions of mankind requires that they should declare the causes which impel them to the separation. We hold these

NATIONAL ARCHIVES SET IN CASLON

**The Declaration of Independence**  
1776 • DUNLAP SETTING  
Digital \$9 • Print \$46 • Edition \$175

THE CONSTITUTION OF THE UNITED STATES, 1787

We the People

of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defence, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity, do ordain and establish this Constitution for the United States of America.

NATIONAL ARCHIVES SET IN CASLON

**Preamble to the Constitution**  
1787 • PHILADELPHIA  
Digital \$9 • Print \$44 • Edition \$165

CONGRESS OF THE UNITED STATES, 1789

The Bill of Rights

AMENDMENT I. Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of religion, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof; or abridging the freedom of speech, or of the press; or the right of the people peaceably to assemble, and to petition the Government for a redress of grievances. AMENDMENT II. A well regulated Militia, being necessary to the security of a free State, the right of the people to keep and bear Arms, shall not be infringed. AMENDMENT III. No Soldier shall, in time of peace be quartered in any house, without the consent of the Owner, nor in time of war, but in a manner to be prescribed by law. AMENDMENT IV. The right of the people to be secure in their persons, houses, papers, and effects, against unreasonable searches and seizures, shall not be violated.

NATIONAL ARCHIVES WATERFIED 1791

**The Bill of Rights**  
1791 • AMENDMENTS I TO X  
Digital \$9 • Print \$46 • Edition \$175

GETTYSBURG, NOVEMBER 19, 1863

Four score and seven years ago

our fathers brought forth on this continent, a new nation, conceived in Liberty, and dedicated to the proposition that all men are created equal. Now we are engaged in a great civil war, testing whether that nation, or any nation so conceived and so dedicated, can long endure.

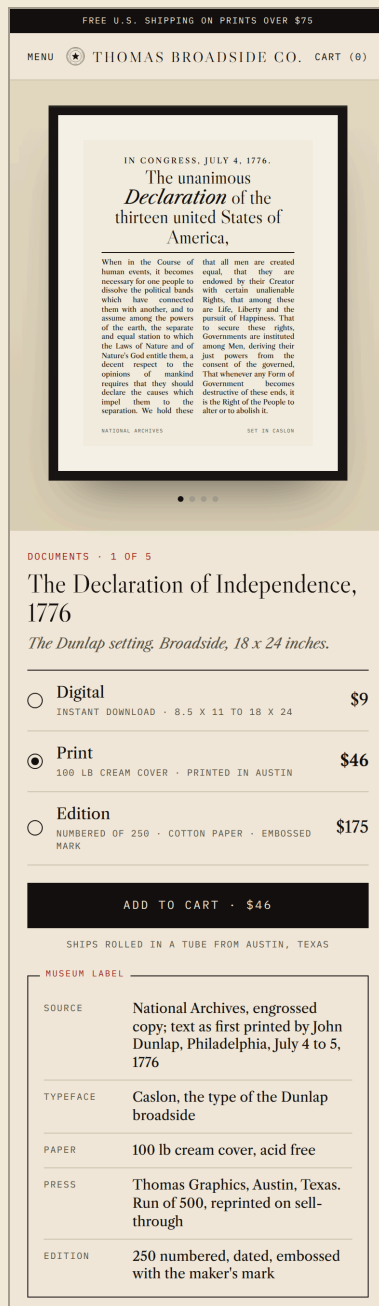
LIBRARY OF CONGRESS BLISS COPY

**The Gettysburg Address**  
1863 • BLISS COPY  
Digital \$9 • Print \$44 • Edition \$165

THE DOCUMENTS. THREE PRICES ON EVERY CARD. THE DIGITAL PRICE IS THE DOORWAY; THE PRINT IS THE SALE.

V

# A product page that reads like a museum label.



PRODUCT PAGE, MOBILE. MOST  
PINTEREST AND INSTAGRAM  
TRAFFIC ARRIVES HERE.

## HOW THE STORE WORKS

### The label

Every product carries source, typeface, paper, press, and edition. This is the brand promise made visible, and it is what a competitor with a Canva template cannot write.

### Three buys

Digital, print, and edition on one page. Nobody leaves because the price was wrong.

### The Press

A page for the shop itself: the family, the equipment, the runs, the video. The About page is the thesis from page two.

### Journal

One entry per anniversary. Each entry is also the pin set, the email, and the reason to reprint.

### Shipping

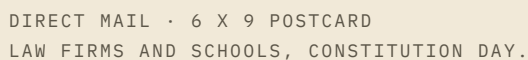
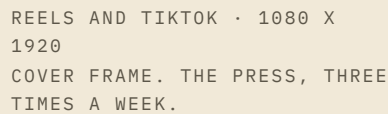
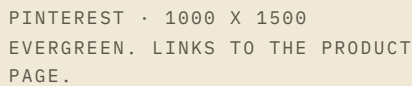
Rolled in a tube from Austin. Free in the U.S. on prints over \$75. Sets ship in one tube.

### Etsy

The same catalog runs on Etsy for its first sixty days as a demand test. Winners get their Shopify pages tuned; Etsy stays on as a discovery channel, never the home.

Design system: Caslon for everything set in type, IBM Plex Mono for labels and figures, cream stock, black ink, and one red. The store looks like the sheets it sells.

# Four sheets, four channels.



Each sheet says the same three things in the same order: the document, the press, the place. The type is the brand, so the ads cost nothing but a photograph of the shop floor. The only production spend is video: the press running, sheets coming off, tubes packed by hand. That is footage no print-on-demand seller can make, and it is the entire content engine.

Paid spend is a test budget only, roughly \$450 a month in year one, spent where the organic channel already works: promoted pins on the winning designs, and a boosted classroom post in August.

VII

# Pinterest brings them. The press keeps them.

PINTEREST · THE PRIMARY ENGINE

Pins live for years, and posters and printables are a core category. Five pins a day, scheduled, each linking to a product page. Boards by line. Sixty pins banked before launch.

SHORT VIDEO · THE SHOP FLOOR

The press running, sheets coming off, tubes packed by hand, three times a week on Reels and TikTok. The one asset competitors cannot fake carries the whole channel.

ETSY FOR DISCOVERY, SHOPIFY FOR THE BRAND

Etsy validates which designs pull demand in sixty days, cheaply. Shopify is the home, the list, and the margin. Etsy stays on as a storefront window.

DIRECT MAIL · A PRINT FAMILY WITH A MAILHOUSE

Paper is nearly free for us. A printed catalog each fall, postcards to opted-in buyers on Constitution Day and before the holidays, and a business mailing to law firms, private schools, co-ops, museum shops, and veterans' posts. Nobody else in this category can afford this.

EMAIL · THE DOWNLOAD IS THE LIST

Every digital purchase is an address. One note per anniversary, with the journal entry and the sheet we printed for it. No weekly newsletters.

DEMAND MINING

Before the first run, embed and cluster the category's Etsy and Pinterest listings to find the underserved niches, the same method we use on labor markets. The second sixteen designs come from that map.

WEEKLY CADENCE

| CHANNEL           | CADENCE                                                                                | OWNER AND COST                    |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Pinterest         | Five pins a day, scheduled a month ahead                                               | Jacob · scheduler subscription    |
| Reels and TikTok  | Three shop-floor videos a week, thirty seconds each                                    | Shop floor · a phone and a tripod |
| Journal and email | One entry per anniversary, roughly twice a month                                       | Jacob · Shopify email             |
| Direct mail       | Catalog in October; postcards in September and November; business mailing in September | The mailhouse · paper and postage |
| Etsy              | Listings synced from Shopify; sixty-day test, then maintenance                         | Jacob · fees on sales             |

## VIII

# The anniversaries are the editorial calendar for a decade.

## THE FIRST YEAR

- SEP 17, 2026 • Constitution Day. Soft launch, digital catalog only. Store live, sixty pins banked, first five videos, business mailing to law firms.
- OCT 2026 • First press run: the top four sellers from the Etsy test. Printed catalog mails.
- NOV 11, 2026 • Veterans Day. The Farewell Address and the Gettysburg Address.
- DEC 15, 2026 • Bill of Rights Day. Holiday postcard, framed editions, the gift push.
- JAN 31, 2027 • The decision gate. Run the press again, or stay digital.
- FEB 15, 2027 • Presidents' Day. The Founders series.
- MAR 2, 2027 • Texas Independence Day. The Texas line, and the home market.
- JUL 4, 2027 • Independence Day. The Declaration edition.
- AUG 2027 • Back to school. The classroom sets, wholesale to co-ops and schools.

## THE DECADE • REVOLUTION 250

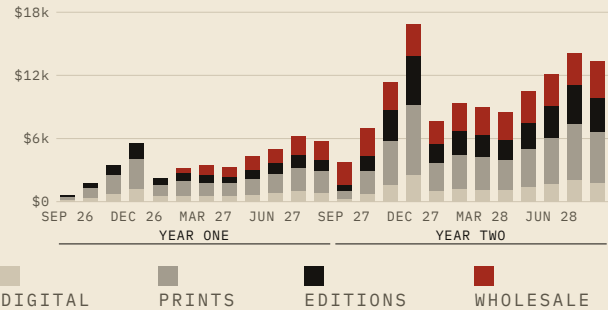
- OCT 17, 2027 • Saratoga at 250. The battle that brought France into the war. New map.
- DEC 19, 2027 • Valley Forge at 250.
- JUN 28, 2028 • Monmouth at 250.
- SEP 23, 2029 • Bonhomme Richard at 250.
- OCT 19, 2031 • Yorktown at 250.
- SEP 3, 2033 • Treaty of Paris at 250.
- SEP 17, 2037 • The Constitution at 250.

Each date is a journal entry, a pin set, an email, a video, and a reason to reprint. The calendar writes the content plan; we only have to keep the appointments. Every July 4 and every August are the two fixed peaks: the edition and the classroom.

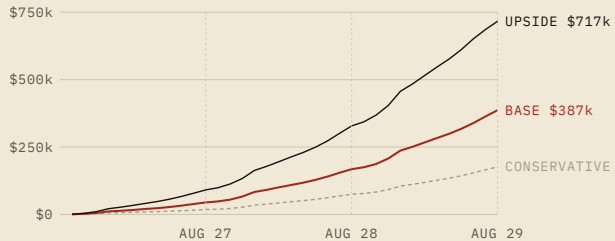
IX

# Three years, three scenarios.

MONTHLY REVENUE BY TIER · BASE CASE · YEARS ONE AND TWO



CUMULATIVE REVENUE · THREE SCENARIOS · 36 MONTHS



| SCENARIO     | YEAR ONE |         |              | YEAR TWO |          |              | YEAR THREE |          |              |
|--------------|----------|---------|--------------|----------|----------|--------------|------------|----------|--------------|
|              | ORDERS   | REVENUE | CONTRIBUTION | ORDERS   | REVENUE  | CONTRIBUTION | ORDERS     | REVENUE  | CONTRIBUTION |
| Conservative | 573      | \$18.4k | -\$2.3k      | 1,286    | \$56.7k  | \$18.0k      | 2,069      | \$101.7k | \$34.7k      |
| Base         | 1,164    | \$44.6k | \$13.4k      | 2,595    | \$123.3k | \$57.2k      | 4,174      | \$218.8k | \$102.8k     |
| Upside       | 2,121    | \$91.3k | \$40.8k      | 4,706    | \$237.1k | \$123.3k     | 7,501      | \$388.1k | \$203.6k     |

YEAR ONE RUNS SEPTEMBER 2026 THROUGH AUGUST 2027. CONTRIBUTION IS GROSS PROFIT LESS FIXED COSTS, WITH THE \$5,200 STARTUP CHARGED TO YEAR ONE, BEFORE JACOB'S TIME AND THE SHOP'S LABOR ON RUNS.

ASSUMPTIONS

- Base case: 1,145 consumer orders in year one, peaking in December and July; 2.2x growth in year two, 1.6x in year three.
- Year-one mix: 60% digital, 35% press prints, 5% editions, shifting toward print over time.
- Average order: digital \$12, print \$46, edition \$170, wholesale \$430. Margins 88%, 62%, 58%, 45%.
- Wholesale from February 2027: one to four orders a month, five to eight in year two.
- Fixed costs \$780 a month in year one (Shopify, apps, test ads, samples), \$1,400 and \$2,200 after.
- Conservative halves demand and delays wholesale six months. Upside is 1.8x demand, wholesale from December 2026.

PAYBACK AND THE GATE

The base case pays back the startup in January 2027; the upside in December 2026; the conservative case in December 2027. By the January 31 decision gate the three scenarios have produced roughly 215, 430, and 780 orders and \$6.8k, \$13.7k, and \$27.2k in revenue.

|                                   |                           |                             |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|
| CONSERVATIVE<br>\$18k<br>YEAR ONE | BASE<br>\$45k<br>YEAR ONE | UPSIDE<br>\$91k<br>YEAR ONE |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|

A small business with excellent margins, not a rocket: a durable cash-flow asset that compounds with the anniversaries, on equipment we already own.

X

# Three phases and one gate.

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SEP 2026        | <div>●</div> <b>Build and soft launch.</b><br>Brand, sixteen designs in two formats, Shopify and Etsy live, sixty pins banked, five videos. Digital only on Constitution Day.                                                            |
| OCT TO DEC 2026 | <div>●</div> <b>Print and push.</b><br>First press run of the top four sellers. Holiday campaign, framed editions through a local framer, Bill of Rights Day mailing. Etsy test concludes.                                               |
| JAN 31, 2027    | <div>●</div> <b>The gate.</b><br>Below roughly 150 orders or \$5,000: the store stays a passive digital catalog with no further press runs. Above: run the full catalog, open wholesale, build the classroom line for August.            |
| 2027            | <div>●</div> <b>Scale on the calendar.</b><br>Presidents' Day, Texas Independence, July 4, back to school, Saratoga and Valley Forge. Wholesale to law firms, schools, co-ops, museum shops. Second sixteen designs from the demand map. |

| STARTUP CAPITAL               |         |
|-------------------------------|---------|
| First press run, four designs | \$3,000 |
| Tubes, packaging, labels      | \$700   |
| Photography, samples, props   | \$600   |
| Framer samples                | \$500   |
| Entity, domain, brand         | \$400   |
| Total                         | \$5,200 |

| RISKS AND RULES |                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Marks           | Official seals, military insignia, the Park Service arrowhead, and the America250 mark are restricted even when the art is public domain. We use none of them, and every source is verified before it goes on a sheet. |
| Price           | Never compete on price on Etsy. Provenance is the moat; discounting erases it.                                                                                                                                         |
| Data            | Etsy buyer data cannot be used for off-platform mail. Postcards go to Shopify opt-ins and business lists only.                                                                                                         |
| Hands           | One named owner for printing, packing, and shipping before launch. A late tube costs more than a sale.                                                                                                                 |



## WORDS TO LIVE WITH

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This proposal was set in Libre Caslon, an open revival of the letters William Caslon cut in London in the 1720s and the face of the first printed Declaration, with IBM Plex Mono for figures. The mockups, ads, and projection were built in August 2026 by Jacob E. Thomas, PhD, for Thomas Graphics Inc., Austin, Texas.

Working name and prices are for discussion. Every figure in the projection is an explicit assumption and can be changed in an afternoon.